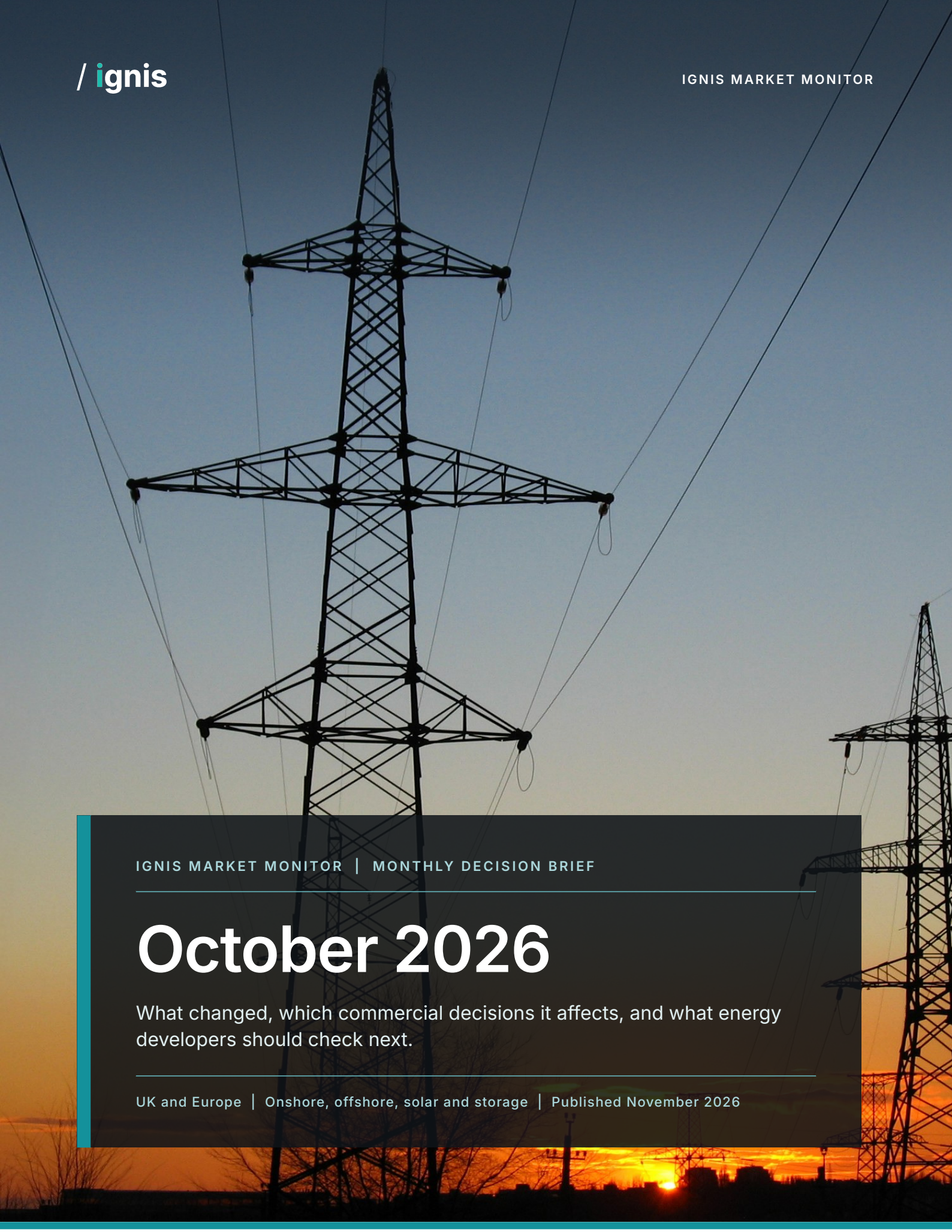


IGNIS MARKET MONITOR | MONTHLY DECISION BRIEF

October 2026

What changed, which commercial decisions it affects, and what energy developers should check next.

UK and Europe | Onshore, offshore, solar and storage | Published November 2026

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ignisleadership.com

Not legal, regulatory or investment advice. Facts checked 16 October to 2 November 2026.

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IGNIS MARKET MONITOR

October 2026

Gas sets the price, and the rules set the timetable. Read through four commercial lenses: strategy, business development, procurement and route to market.

Data checked 16 to 20 October 2026
Published November 2026
8 minute read

> What changed, which commercial decisions it affects, and what energy developers should check next.

1 THREE DECISIONS THIS MONTH

1

ROUTE TO MARKET | ONSHORE WIND, SOLAR, BESS

Fix PPA or toll prices now, and at what tenor?

GB spot power doubled to £145/MWh, driven by gas [1, 2]. The forward premium sits in 2027: Summer-27 at £127.36/MWh, Summer-28 at £80.69 [3, 4].

Before you sign terms or price a bid

2

BID STRATEGY | AR8 POTS 1 TO 4

What single capacity, delivery year and walk-away price will you bid?

Each project gets one sealed bid, with no smaller or later fallback [5]. Budgets are due on 19 November [6, 7].

Settle before 19 November

3

PORTFOLIO STRATEGY | GATE 2 OFFERS

Sign and secure the offer, or let it go?

Offers come with 90 days to sign and 30 more to place securities, and milestones run back from the connection date [8, 9].

By each offer's deadline

What this report covers

GB power and gas, UK CfD auctions and grid connections, European offshore wind tenders, deals and procurement prices. Each signal is read for what it means for an energy developer's commercial strategy, business development (pipeline, partners, offtakers, bids), procurement and route to market, and where agentic AI can carry the groundwork.

How to read a signal

Signal and **Timing** report sourced facts, numbered [n] to the source register. **Exposure**, **Decision**, **Evidence** and **Where agentic AI helps** are the Ignis view, with no results claimed. **Confidence** separates what is known from what is not. IGNIS ASSUMPTION marks our estimates; NOT VERIFIED marks what we could not confirm.

INSIDE: THE SIGNALS BEHIND THE DECISIONS

Major 1. GB power and gas	Power has doubled, and gas explains nearly all of it.	page 3
Major 2. AR8	One sealed bid per project against a fixed cap.	page 4
Major 3. Gate 2	Offers are landing, and each one starts a clock.	page 5
Major 4. AO10 and capital	France's bids are in, and offshore capital is being recycled.	page 6
Minor signals	European offshore rules, storage capital, procurement prices.	page 6
Also inside	3 Who is affected. 4 Evidence to update. 5 What to watch. 6 Key dates. 7 Method and sources.	page 7

Published monthly. The full source register is published alongside this report as a separate appendix.

2 WHAT CHANGED

Four major signals and three minor ones

MAJOR SIGNAL 1 GB POWER AND GAS

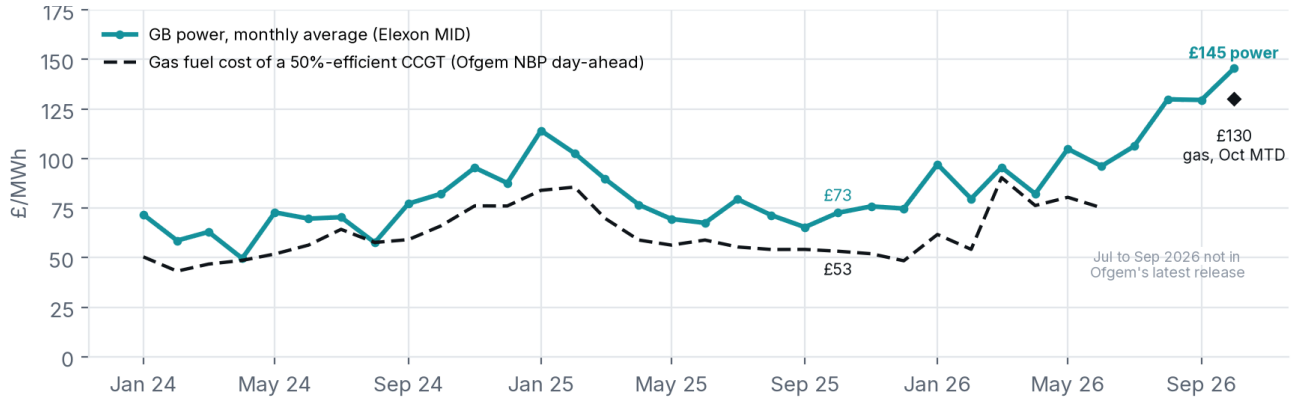
GB power has doubled, and gas explains nearly all of it

£145/MWh
GB spot power, 1 to 17 October, against £73 a year earlier
[1]

+168%
NBP gas, about 217p/therm on 18 October, on a year earlier
[2]

£127.36
Summer-27 power, £/MWh, 16 October; Summer-28 £80.69
[3, 4]

GB power has risen in step with the cost of gas
Monthly GB spot power against the gas cost of 1 MWh from a 50% efficient gas plant (gas only, excluding carbon), £/MWh. October 2026 is month to date.



Sources: Elexon MID to 17 Oct 2026 [1]; Ofgem NBP day-ahead monthly average to Jun 2026 [10]; Purely Energy NBP day-ahead month-to-date to 16 Oct 2026 [4]. Ignis calculation: p/therm × 10 ÷ 29.3071 ÷ 0.5.

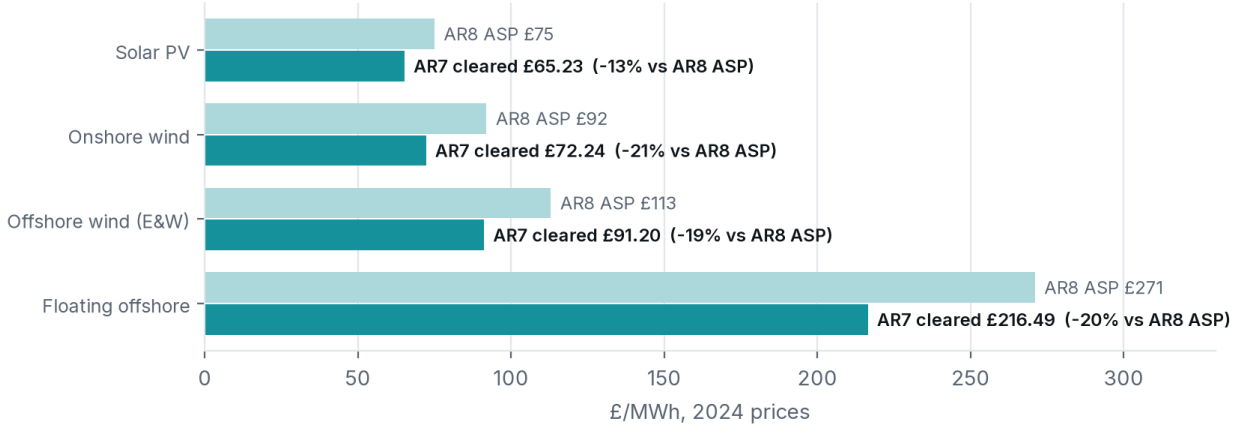
SIGNAL	At 50% efficiency, the fuel cost of a gas plant rose from about £53 to £130/MWh over the year, roughly the whole rise in spot power (Ignis calculation from [1, 4, 10]). The trigger is the Iran conflict and the Strait of Hormuz [11, 12, 3, 13], with Asian LNG at $29.61/MMBtu in the week to 13 October [14]. Forwards put the premium in 2027, not beyond [3, 4].
EXPOSURE IGNIS VIEW	**Route to market:** PPA and toll negotiations under way, and merchant and hybrid revenue cases. **Business development:** offtaker and optimiser conversations priced off October. **Strategy:** any bid or investment case built on a curve from before the summer.
DECISION IGNIS VIEW	**Route to market:** fix PPA or toll prices now and at what tenor, or hold merchant exposure. **Bid strategy:** what walk-away price to carry into AR8 when the merchant alternative looks strong for 2027 only. **Business development:** which offtakers to approach while 2027 prices are high.
EVIDENCE IGNIS VIEW	Date-stamp the curve in every live model. Run a case on the calmer 2028 and 2029 forwards (Summer-29 at £72.80/MWh [4]), not only Summer-27. Test tolls priced off October's volatility against that calmer curve.
WHERE AGENTIC AI HELPS IGNIS VIEW	Agents can re-run each live model on the latest forward curve every week, flag where a PPA or toll price breaks the walk-away case, and keep a dated record of which curve backed which decision. The commercial team decides tenor, price and counterparty.
TIMING	Now, before PPA terms or bid prices are fixed, and through the winter while gas storage is low.
CONFIDENCE	**Known:** spot and forward settlements. **Uncertain:** winter. EU storage started winter 72% full against 83% a year earlier, and in a cold winter ENTSOG sees it falling to about 11% by the end of March [15, 16]. NESO's June early view still expects adequate GB margins [17]. Most price figures come from broker and consultancy notes, not exchange data.

MAJOR SIGNAL 2 UK CFD ALLOCATION ROUND 8

AR8 gives each project one sealed bid against a fixed cap

AR7 cleared well below the AR8 price caps

AR7 clearing prices against AR8 administrative strike prices, £/MWh in 2024 prices. Offshore shows England and Wales; Scotland cleared at £89.49.



Sources: LCCC CfD auction outcomes AR1 to AR7 [18]; DESNZ AR8 Pot and Price Notice, Table 2 [19].

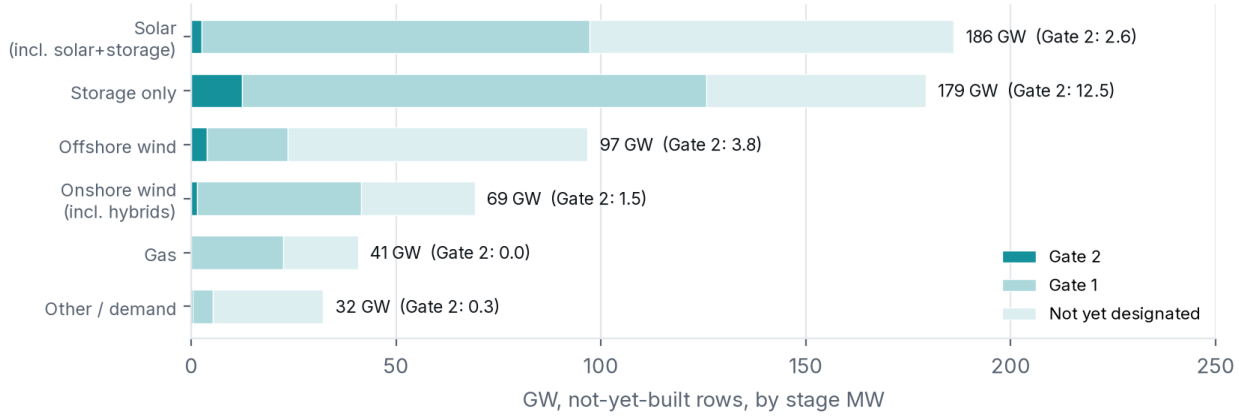
SIGNAL	AR8 caps are £75/MWh for solar, £92 for onshore wind, £113 for offshore and £271 for floating (2024 prices); AR7 cleared 13%, 21%, 19% and 20% below them [19, 18]. In Pots 1 to 4 each project may submit only one sealed bid: one strike price, one capacity and one set of target dates (Rules 13.1 and 13.3) [5]. Flexible bids survive only in Pot 5 (Rule 13.7) [5]. Government sees anonymised bids that do not fit the budget and will only add budget for bids it judges strong value for money, weighing technologies against each other [19].
EXPOSURE IGNIS VIEW	**Route to market and bids:** solar (Pot 1), onshore and remote island wind (Pot 2), offshore (Pot 3), floating and deep-water (Pot 4); solar and onshore wind lose the fallback variants they have had since 2014 [20, 21, 22]. **Procurement:** supply and EPC quotes must hold to the bid.
DECISION IGNIS VIEW	**Route to market:** CfD as the anchor or a corporate PPA, with the other as fallback. **Bid strategy:** one capacity, one delivery year and one walk-away price, settled before bidding; a bid just outside the budget depends on Government rating it good value. **Procurement:** quote validity matched to the bid window.
EVIDENCE IGNIS VIEW	Supply and EPC quotes valid beyond the bid window; the connection date behind the delivery year; the curve behind the merchant alternative; the fallback route to market if the bid fails.
WHERE AGENTIC AI HELPS IGNIS VIEW	Agents can assemble the bid evidence pack, checking quote validity, connection date, curve date and fallback route against the bid settings before submission. The bid committee sets capacity, delivery year and price.
TIMING	Budget notice and Notice of Auction on 19 November; indicative sealed bid window 3 to 9 December [23]; results expected 15 to 17 February 2027 [6, 7].
CONFIDENCE	**Known:** caps, bid rules and the 19 November date. **Uncertain:** pot budgets, and every date after 19 November until the Notice of Auction confirms it [23].

MAJOR SIGNAL 3 GB GRID CONNECTIONS

Gate 2 offers are landing, and each one starts a clock

Most of the transmission queue is not yet at Gate 2

Transmission Entry Capacity not yet built, by technology and Gate status, GW. 16 October 2026 TEC Register.



Source: NESO TEC Register, 16 Oct 2026 [24]. Ignis calculation: rows not marked Built, summed MW increase or decrease. "Not yet designated" is our label for rows with a blank Gate field.

SIGNAL	NESO's extended deadline for the last Phase 1 transmission offers, about 62 of them, is 31 October; Phase 1 distribution offers complete by 30 November, Phase 2 transmission by 31 January 2027 and distribution by 31 March 2027 [25, 26]. Of 604 GW in the transmission queue not yet built, 20.8 GW carries a Gate 2 label (Ignis calculation from [24]). The field fills only on countersignature; by 10 June, Gate 2 offers had gone to 713 projects (37 GW) [27].
EXPOSURE IGNIS VIEW	**Strategy:** which projects in the pipeline keep a credible date. **Business development:** partners, investors and landowners whose terms depend on the connection date. Storage most of all: 113 GW at Gate 1 and 12.5 GW at Gate 2 [24].
DECISION IGNIS VIEW	**Strategy:** sign and secure the offer, or let it lapse and re-plan the pipeline. **Procurement and route to market:** whether equipment commitments and revenue agreements still match the offered date and cost.
EVIDENCE IGNIS VIEW	For a NESO offer: sign within 90 days, then place securities within 30 days; securities are updated every six months [8]. Milestones run back from the connection date: begin consents (M1), secure consents (M2), secure land rights (M3); missing the early ones means termination unless an exception applies [9]. Cutting declared capacity triggers cancellation charges [8]. Check each against land options, the consent timetable and revenue dates.
WHERE AGENTIC AI HELPS IGNIS VIEW	Agents can track each offer's signing, security and milestone dates against land options, consent timetables and revenue dates, and raise exceptions early. Named people decide to sign, secure or let go.
TIMING	NGED acceptance deadlines on 26 October and 2, 9, 16 and 23 November [28]; 90 day signing windows from each transmission offer [8]. A lapsed Gate 2 offer is followed by a residual Gate 1 offer within 6 weeks [26].
CONFIDENCE	**Known:** deadlines and offer rules. NOT VERIFIED the Phase 1 capacity still to be issued. A blank or Gate 1 register row is not a verdict on a project; the offer letter is what counts.

MAJOR SIGNAL 4 EUROPEAN OFFSHORE WIND

France's AO10 bids are in, and offshore capital is being recycled

About 10 GW
AO10 bids across 11 projects, closed 12 October [29, 30]

70 / 18 / 6 / 6
Price, robustness, carbon, European content. Below 11 of 18 on robustness is eliminated [31]

€100/MWh
Capacity-weighted average target across all AO10 winners [31, 32]

SIGNAL	AO10 splits into about 5.25 GW of fixed-bottom (four projects) and 4.9 GW of floating (seven), by Ignis arithmetic from the DGEC list [33], under a €63bn, 25 year scheme approved by the European Commission [34]. If the €100/MWh target is exceeded, CRE drops projects, latest grid dates and highest prices first [31, 32]. In the UK, RWE completed the sale of its Five Estuaries stake to EDF, CIP bought 25% of the project, and Ørsted is buying back 49.9% of Gunfleet Sands 1 and 2 [35, 36, 37].
EXPOSURE IGNIS VIEW	**Business development:** AO10 consortium partners, and buyers and sellers of UK offshore stakes. **Procurement:** supply chain slots for AO10 bidders. **Strategy:** holders of development stakes and of operating farms near late life.
DECISION IGNIS VIEW	**Business development:** partner governance before award, and who joins or exits. **Procurement:** which supply chain slots and financing terms to line up for the first 90 days after award. **Strategy:** recycle development stakes or consolidate operating assets.
EVIDENCE IGNIS VIEW	The robustness file behind the 18 points; a consortium that meets the 500 MW and €1bn entry thresholds [31]; a post-award plan that does not wait for February.
WHERE AGENTIC AI HELPS IGNIS VIEW	Agents can keep the robustness evidence file current, track partner and supply chain commitments, and draft the post-award plan from them. The consortium board decides partners, terms and financing.
TIMING	CRE ranks offers by 4 January 2027 (18 January at the latest), with winners expected in February [29, 38], in the same window as AR8 results [6, 7].
CONFIDENCE	**Known:** rules and timetable. **Uncertain:** floating appetite. Spinergie estimates around 330 floaters for the tender [39]; TotalEnergies' chief executive has said the company is no longer interested in floating wind [40]. Capital recycling is an Ignis reading of four deals, not a trend statistic [35, 36, 37, 41].

Minor signals

Each moves one assumption, not a whole plan. BD is business development. Exposure, Decision and Evidence are the Ignis view.

SIGNAL	EXPOSURE	DECISION	EVIDENCE	TIMING	CONFIDENCE
EUROPEAN OFFSHORE RULES **Support returns to offshore tenders**					
Netherlands: Gamma-A maximum bid raised to €117/MWh [42, 43]. Belgium: two-sided CfD, no maximum strike price, pending state aid [44, 45, 46]. Germany: subsidy-free first, CfD fallback; draft only [47, 48].	**Strategy, BD:** offshore developers picking 2027 markets	Where to send bid teams and partners	Revenue model per market	26 Nov to 10 Dec [43]	Dutch rules final; Belgian and German not yet
GB STORAGE CAPITAL **BESS capital follows contracted revenue**					
Kilmarnock South (350 MW) reached FID with a Shell optimisation agreement [49]; Hunterston (400 MW) closed on a BP toll and a Danske Commodities floor [50]; Dalmarnock (40 MW) connected with a 10 year EDF floor [51].	**Route to market, BD:** BESS developers raising capital	Floor or toll now, or stay merchant	Terms tested on a calmer 2028	Capacity Market, Mar 2027 [52]	Three deals; the pattern is an Ignis reading

SIGNAL	EXPOSURE	DECISION	EVIDENCE	TIMING	CONFIDENCE
PROCUREMENT **Module and cell prices are soft**					
Rotterdam TOPCon module prices fell about 5.8% from 3 July to 25 September [53] and stayed under pressure in mid-October [54]. China LFP cell prices eased in the week to 14 October; system prices held flat [55].	**Procurement, bids:** solar and BESS in tender	When to refresh quotes and fix supply terms	Quote valid past the bid	Before the AR8 bid window [23]	Not GB delivered EPC prices

3 WHO AND WHAT IS AFFECTED

Where each signal lands

Ignis view of exposure by commercial lens. High means a live decision this quarter; Medium means an assumption to check; Low means watch only. The developer types most exposed are named in each signal's Exposure field.

SIGNAL	COMMERCIAL STRATEGY	BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT	PROCUREMENT	ROUTE TO MARKET
1 Power and gas	Medium	High	Low	High
2 AR8 sealed bid	High	Medium	High	High
3 Gate 2 offers	High	Medium	Medium	Medium
4 AO10 and offshore capital	High	High	Medium	Low
European offshore rules	Medium	Medium	Low	Medium
BESS contracted revenue	Low	High	Low	High
Procurement prices	Low	Low	High	Medium

4 EVIDENCE OR ASSUMPTIONS TO UPDATE

Eight checks for your models and decision papers

ASSUMPTION	UPDATE OR CHECK	SOURCE
Power price curve	Re-date it. Run Summer-27 at £127.36/MWh and Summer-28 at £80.69 as separate cases.	[3, 4]
Gas and winter risk	Add a cold winter case: EU storage started at 72% against 83% a year earlier.	[15, 16]
AR8 bid settings	One capacity, one delivery year, one price per project in Pots 1 to 4.	[5]
AR8 price headroom	Measure bid price against the cap, not against AR7 clearing alone.	[19, 18]
Connection date	Use the date in the Gate 2 offer letter, not the register row.	[24, 8]
Security and cash	Budget securities within 30 days of signing, revised every six months.	[8]
Milestone plan	Map M1 to M3 to consents and land rights, with slack.	[9]
Supply and EPC prices	Refresh quotes before pricing a bid; modules and cells are soft.	[53, 55]

5 WHAT TO WATCH NEXT

Triggers that would change a decision

WATCH FOR	WHY IT MATTERS	SOURCE
AR8 pot budgets and Notice of Auction, 19 November	Sets how much headroom each pot has and confirms the sealed bid dates.	[6, 7, 23]
EU and UK summit, 20 November	Carbon market linking would move UK ETS prices, now £65.92/t against a £49.41/t reference [14, 56].	[14]
Ofgem LDES Window 1 final decision	Due "later in autumn". NOT VERIFIED exact timing.	[57]
NESO Winter Outlook 2026/27	NOT VERIFIED the full outlook was not found; we rely on the June early view.	[17]
Germany's offshore act and Belgium's state aid approval	Decide whether two more markets open for 2027 bids.	[47, 48, 46]

6 KEY DATES AND DECISION WINDOWS

What is due, and when you need to have decided

DATE	WHAT IS DUE	WHO IT TOUCHES	DECISION WINDOW	SOURCE
OCTOBER AND NOVEMBER 2026				
26 Oct to 23 Nov	NGED Phase 1 acceptance deadlines, Batches 5 to 9 (26 Oct; 2, 9, 16, 23 Nov)	Projects at those grid supply points	Accept, or the offer lapses	[28, 26]
31 Oct	Last Phase 1 transmission offers	About 62 projects	90 days to sign	[25, 8]
10 Nov	Botley West consent decision	Large solar	Watch	[58]
19 Nov	AR8 budget notice and Notice of Auction	Pots 1 to 4 applicants	Bid settings agreed by now	[6, 7]
20 Nov	EU and UK summit	Gas-set power prices	Watch	[14]
20 and 27 Nov	NGED Batches 10 and 11 issued	Projects at those grid supply points	Accept by 28 Dec and 4 Jan	[28]
26 Nov to 10 Dec	IJmuiden Ver Gamma-A bid window	Offshore bidders	Bid, maximum €117/MWh	[43]
30 Nov	Phase 1 distribution offers complete	Local network projects	Each offer's deadline	[25]
DECEMBER 2026 TO MARCH 2027				
3 to 9 Dec	AR8 sealed bid window, indicative	Pots 1 to 4 applicants	One bid per project	[23]
4 Jan 2027	CRE ranking of AO10 offers (18 Jan at the latest)	AO10 bidders	Post-award plan ready	[29]
31 Jan 2027	Phase 2 transmission offers	Projects needed 2031 to 2035	90 days to sign	[25, 8]
15 to 17 Feb 2027	AR8 results expected; AO10 winners in February	AR8 and AO10 bidders	Fallback route ready	[6, 7, 29]
March 2027	Capacity Market auctions, T-1 and T-4	BESS and flexible plant	Prequalified bids	[52]
31 Mar 2027	Phase 2 distribution offers complete	Local network projects	Each offer's deadline	[25]

7 METHOD AND SELECTED SOURCES

Method

Market data checked 16 to 18 October 2026; storage, offshore and procurement items 17 to 20 October 2026. Wholesale power is the simple average of half-hourly Elexon APXMIDP prices with non-zero volume; October is month to date. Gas cost of power: NBP p/therm × 10 ÷ 29.3071 gives £/MWh of gas, divided by 0.5 for a 50% efficient gas plant, Ofgem's central spark spread assumption [10]. Gas storage uses GIE's official EU figure for 1 October [15]. TEC figures sum rows not marked Built [24]. CfD prices are in 2024 prices. Deals cover announcements from 1 to 20 October 2026.

How it is produced. Agents gather and cross-check public sources against a fixed coverage list and draft the signal blocks; a named Ignis editor checks every figure against its source and writes every judgement before publication.

Every number carries a source number. The full source register for this report, with every link, is published separately as the October 2026 source register (PDF and web page).

Selected sources

1 Elexon Insights Solution API, Market Index Data (APXMIDP), downloaded 18 Oct 2026 via the Insights API

4 Purely Energy, "Today's UK wholesale prices" (settlements to 16 Oct 2026), accessed 18 Oct 2026.

5 DESNZ, AR8 Contract Allocation Framework, 2026.

8 NESO, "Connections Reform What Next: Post Notifications Customer Handbook", December 2025.

19 DESNZ, CfD AR8 Pot and Price Notice, 6 Jul 2026.

23 Rendaq, "AR8 timetable confirmed: results now due in February 2027", 15 Oct 2026. Indicative sealed bid window 3 to 9 Dec 2026; dates after 19 Nov indicative until the Notice of Auction.

24 NESO, TEC Register, 16 Oct 2026 (CSV).

25 Ofgem, agreement to a further alternative timetable for Gate 2 Phase 1 offers (G2tWQ), 2 Oct 2026.

29 CRE, Appel d'offres n°1/2026 (AO10) page (accessed 18 Oct 2026).

31 CRE, AO10 cahier des charges (procédure d'appel d'offres n°1/2026), Art. 1.1, 3.2, 3.2.4, 3.3.5.

If one of these decisions is on your desk

Ignis helps energy developers turn changing project evidence into controlled commercial decisions from development to financial close. We advise on commercial strategy, business development, procurement and route to market, and on the agentic AI transformation of the work behind them: advisory led and hands-on, built with your team. You own and run the system.

Want to talk it through? 30 minutes, no pitch. Book a call, write to yorik@ignisleadership.com, or get Signal, the weekly note on what moved in energy, at ignisleadership.com/insights.

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Agentic Transformation for Energy Developers
Guide

Route to Market for Energy Developers
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Procurement for Energy Developers
Control playbook

Ignis Market Monitor
Monthly decision brief | This report

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